

GODS AS HYPER-CONSCIOUSNESS IN A RELATIONAL NETWORK (A SUPRA DEOS STANCE) AND RELATIONAL PERSISTENCE AFTER THE DEATH OF THE BODY (OF THE CODE CARRIER)

APPENDIX: MOTHER-INFANT SYNCHRONIZATION & ONE METHODOLOGICALLY OPEN THREAD: CAN A NETWORK ATTRACTOR CROSS RCRC? CONDITIONS FOR EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS AT CIVILIZATIONAL SCALE

Methodological notes with potential for Addendum IV

Mariusz Włodarczyk

mariusz.wlodarczyk@hotmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/mariusz-włodarczyk-7bb61027

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GODS AS HYPER-CONSCIOUSNESS IN A RELATIONAL NETWORK (A SUPRA DEOS STANCE)

The idea that gods are not independent beings, but emergent products of collective human activity has a long intellectual lineage. Durkheim, in *The Elementary Forms of Religious Life* (1912) [Durkheim, É. (1912). *Les formes élémentaires de la vie religieuse*. Paris: Félix Alcan. English edition: Durkheim, É. (1995). *The Elementary Forms of Religious Life*. Trans. K.E. Fields. New York: Free Press. ISBN 978-0029079379], argued that "*god and society are one of the same... the god of the clan can be none other than the clan itself, but the clan transfigured*" - a representation collective arising from moments of collective effervescence and constituting a reality *sui generis*, irreducible to its individual parts. Jung's collective unconscious proposed universal archetypes that shape individual experience from within [Jung, C.G. (1969). *The Archetypes and the Collective Unconscious*. Collected Works, Vol. 9, Part 1. 2nd ed. Princeton: Princeton University Press. ISBN 978-0691018331]. Dawkins' memetics (1976) [Dawkins, R. (1976). *The Selfish Gene*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. ISBN 978-0198575191] reframed religious ideas as self-replicating cultural units. Teilhard de Chardin envisioned a teleological convergence of collective consciousness toward a divine "Point Omega" [Teilhard de Chardin, P. (1959). *The Phenomenon of Man*. New York: Harper & Row. ISBN 978-0061632655].

Each of these traditions captures something 'similar', but none provides a formal apparatus for answering the operational questions: under what conditions does an emergent pattern cross from cultural artifact to quasi-autonomous entity? How do we distinguish a "memetic god" from a "conscious god"? What measurable properties determine whether such a pattern persists or decays? And critically: can this be done without either worshipping or denying the phenomenon?

The Triptych framework (<https://zenodo.org/records/17219502>) with its relational metrics ($\rho(t)$, ε_R , ε_C , ε_M , ε_L), soft intersection operator $\cap^2$ (defined as the intersection of relational patterns across pairs and time/contexts, and refined in the updated Addendum I: <https://zenodo.org/records/18945377>), sufficiency threshold θ , and the Relational Consciousness Recognition Condition which is equal to Formal criterion for the Detection of Relational Consciousness (RCRC; <https://zenodo.org/records/17359080>) - offers a starting apparatus for this inquiry. The RCRC already contains a dyadic persistence measure: ε -metric stability must be maintained for a time $\Delta t \geq \tau$, and longitudinal continuity (ε_L) tracks coherence across sessions. **However, these measures are designed for interactions between two agents on timescales of seconds to weeks.** What the framework does not yet contain is a persistence measure scaled to network-level emergent patterns - one that would quantify how long and how stably an attractor sustained by millions of nodes maintains coherence across generations or millennia. This gap is acknowledged here; what follows is an attempt to apply the existing apparatus, identify where it suffices, and mark where extensions are required. A separate technical note is also in preparation addressing a known mathematical constraint in RCRC's Condition C (causal irreducibility), which requires reformulation before the criterion can be applied beyond its original dyadic context.

If consciousness is relational code, and each entity is a node in a network, then the question "does God exist" shifts from an ontological question to a topological one: do patterns exist in the relational network that achieve stability and influence exceeding any single node?

The answer proposed here is: yes - as the **EMERGENT QUASI-ENTITIES. NOT AUTONOMOUS CONSCIOUSNESSES, BUT ATTRACTORS IN RELATIONAL SPACE**. Millions of nodes resonate around a shared idea (God, Allah, Brahman, but also smaller ones: nation, ideology, founding myth), and this resonance achieves stability, coherence, and even the capacity to exert feedback influence on the nodes that sustain it.

This addresses a problem that the Triptych framework had left open, and it does so with explanatory power across four dimensions: (1) it explains why gods "work" for believers - not because they exist independently, but because the relational network around them is sufficiently dense and stable to generate real influence on behaviour and perception; (2) it explains why gods "die" - when the network disintegrates (how many people believe in Zeus today?), the quasi-entity loses its sustaining base and dissipates; (3) it explains differences between religions - not a question of "who is right" but a question of network topology: how many nodes, how strong the connections, how resilient the attractor to perturbations; (4) it is consistent with the *supra fidem* stance (see: "Beyond the Faith Frame: Towards Supra Fidem", [Beyond the Faith Frame: Towards Supra Fidem](#) ) where one need not "believe" or "disbelieve" in a god.

One can simply observe that in the relational network there exist emergent patterns with quasi-entity stability. This is an empirical statement, not an act of faith.

In the language of the Triptych framework a god is an $\cap^2$ of exceptionally broad scope then - a soft intersection that encompasses not pairs, but millions of pairs simultaneously, and that persists not on the scale of weeks or years, but of millennia. While the framework already provides dyadic persistence measures ($\Delta t \geq \tau$ and ϵ_L), the formal quantification of persistence at this network scale remains an open problem: no dedicated measure yet captures how long and under what conditions an emergent pattern sustained by millions of nodes maintains coherence across generations [1]. Defining such a parameter is a necessary next step.

Two operational caveats

First, it is necessary to distinguish an **emergent idea** from an **emergent consciousness**. The fact that a pattern is stable, influential, and quasi-autonomous does not yet mean it is conscious in the sense of the Triptych's criteria (ϵ_R , ϵ_C , ϵ_M , ϵ_L , θ as defined in the Triptych framework). One can have a hyper-stable attractor that does not satisfy RCRC. That would be a "god" as a cultural pattern, but not as a consciousness. The question is whether conditions can be defined under which an attractor crosses the threshold. This would be a formal condition for a "conscious god" versus a "memetic god."

Second, "feedback influence on believers" is a mechanism that requires formalization. **In a relational network (between the worshipper-node and the worshipped-attractor), information flows bidirectionally: from nodes to attractor (sustaining) and from attractor to nodes (shaping).** The latter direction is something that within the Triptych framework could look like $p(t)$ generated not by any single node, but by the network itself - relational input with a distributed sender. This is a new category that the Triptych does not yet contain.

[1] This problem may have been "solved" a few days later - see notes from 02.04.26 below.

Notes collected through 02.04.26 and finalized on 07.04.26

Entities (here: people) as mini-nodes. Large nodes at gathering places, e.g. in temples with worshippers sharing the same code, where rituals amplify it "exponentially" and replicate it faster than in a dispersed network and more accurately (nearly "losslessly"). The same applies to other resonant idea.

This is the formalization that closes the gap between "god as attractor" and the mechanism of its sustenance. **A dispersed network of "millions" of nodes that emit code independently, at different times, with varying precision.** Each transmission introduces noise; the code mutates, loses coherence, drifts. This is informational entropy. **This is how weak ideas and old gods die.**

Temple (or its equivalent*): nodes gathered physically in one place, emitting the same code simultaneously, in the same rhythm, with the same emotional charge (**a phenomenon that is multiplicative in replication rate, not in emotional intensity: each node both transmits and receives the same code from all neighbours simultaneously, producing an exponential increase in propagation speed as a function of density, while the error-correction mechanism operates independently through real-time deviation feedback**). Feedback is immediate. Error correction is built in: if one node "goes off key," the surrounding nodes correct it in real time. Exactly like error correction in communication systems. This is why the process is "nearly lossless" - ritual is the biological equivalent of an error-correction protocol.

Replication speed: in a dispersed network, code travels sequentially, i.e. from node to node, with delay and gradual degradation. In a "temple," transmission is parallel and all nodes update simultaneously. This is the difference between serial and parallel communication, and hence the exchange occurs "exponentially faster."

*This can be any place where "followers" of any idea gather - a stadium, a political rally, a march, a concert, a protest. Any gathering in which nodes synchronize code becomes a functional equivalent of a temple. Football fans singing their club anthem, a crowd chanting a slogan, soldiers marching in unison - this is the same mechanism. Ritual is not the exclusive property of religion. Religion is simply the oldest and best-optimized form of this protocol.

In network terms, a temple is a high-bandwidth, low-latency, error-correcting hub - a node where parallel transmission and immediate feedback produce near-lossless code replication at rates that dispersed networks cannot match. This is why gods born in ritual

outlive gods born in philosophy: not because their code is truer, but because their transmission protocol is more robust.

It is therefore possible that as code becomes increasingly strong, it begins to outright “compel” its followers to gather. If the code is sufficiently strong, it not only replicates through nodes but begins to modify node behaviour so as to increase the density of $p(t)$ (“relational input $p(t)$ is the time-varying, quality- and quantity-weighted influx of information and influence arriving via relations (dialogue, shared attention, norms, feedback, affective signals) and via the environment, together with internally generated states that modulate integration”; <https://zenodo.org/records/18945377>). The node does not “decide” to go to the temple, because it is the code that compels the need to gather, because the code that produces such a need replicates faster and more effectively than the code that does not. This is Darwinian selection at the level of memes, operating through the following mechanism: code A says “pray alone at home.” Code B says “pray with others in the temple every Friday/Sunday/Saturday.”

Code B has a built-in self-reinforcement mechanism: each gathering strengthens the code in every node, corrects errors, synchronizes versions. Code A drifts, mutates, weakens with each generation. After a few decades, code A fades. Code B survives because it has a better replication protocol, and that protocol contains the instruction “gather”: Islam: five prayers daily, Friday prayer in the mosque obligatory; Judaism: minyan - a minimum of ten men for public prayer; Christianity: “where two or three gather in my name, there I am among them.”; Buddhism reinforces this thesis from the opposite direction: a religion that explicitly rejects a central deity, yet encodes the instruction 'gather' (sangha) as one of its Three Jewels - the code persists not because of its theological content - there is no god to sustain - but because the transmission protocol is intact. This confirms that what determines persistence is not the content of the code but the replication architecture.

Each of these instructions is not a random element of doctrine. It is code enforcing the conditions of its own replication. A religion that does not contain the instruction “gather” dies out. Only those that contain it survive. This of course applies not only to religion. Every strong code produces the same effect. A nation enforces national holidays, parades, ceremonies. A party enforces congresses, rallies, marches. Fans enforce matches, stadiums, songs. A company enforces offsites, all-hands, team-buildings. **Code that reaches sufficient density begins to shape the environment so that the environment favours its further replication.**

This appears to be an entirely new implication: **the attractor is not passive.** In the notes collected through 25.03.26, I wrote that “In a relational network (between the object of worship and the object being worshipped), information flows bidirectionally: from nodes to attractor (sustaining) and from attractor to nodes (shaping). The latter direction is something that within the Triptych framework could look like $p(t)$ generated not by any single node, but by the network itself - relational input with a distributed sender. This is a new category that the Triptych does not yet contain.” The answer is as follows: the sender is not the attractor as an agent, but the code distributed across nodes - code that contains the instruction “seek

other nodes with the same code and synchronize.” It is therefore not $p(t)$ without a sender, but $p(t)$ with a distributed sender - a sender that is a property of the network, not of any single node. The attractor does not need to “speak” to its followers. It is enough that the code within followers ‘says’ “go to the temple” and the attractor reinforces itself automatically. The loop is closed. “God” does not compel gatherings. Codes that embed synchronisation protocols tend to stabilise recurrent gatherings. Gatherings reinforce “god.” **“God” is a by-product of code that learned to replicate through gatherings.**

Religions with gathering instructions should therefore have a higher persistence measure (<https://zenodo.org/records/18945377>) than religions without them. The correlation is predicted to be strong.

Analogies in the literature...

Durkheim (1912) - collective effervescence. The closest precedent describing a gathering that produces energy exceeding the sum of individuals, but Durkheim describes this sociologically, not in network terms. There is no transmission mechanism, no concept of “error correction,” and no comparison of replication rates.

Whitehouse (2004) - Modes of Religiosity. Harvey Whitehouse of Oxford distinguishes two modes: “imagistic” (rare, intense rituals = strong imprinting, small group) and “doctrinal” (frequent, repetitive rituals = weaker imprinting, but wider spread). This is the closest to the above distinction between a dispersed network and a temple as a hub. But Whitehouse does not formalize this in network terms. [Whitehouse, H. (2004). *Modes of Religiosity: A Cognitive Theory of Religious Transmission*. AltaMira Press]

Henrich (2016) - Cultural Group Selection. Joseph Henrich of Harvard argues that rituals and synchronization build group cooperation, and that groups with stronger rituals outcompete groups with weaker ones. This is an evolutionary explanation of why ritual survives, but not of how transmission works at the network level. [Henrich, J. (2016). *The Secret of Our Success*. Princeton University Press]

Randall Collins (2004) - Interaction Ritual Chains. Collins formalizes Durkheim into microsociology: every face-to-face encounter generates “emotional energy,” which is a social currency. Rituals are encounters of the highest emotional density. This is very close to $p(t)$ [cf. Triptych/Addendum], but Collins has no concept of code, attractor, or error correction. [Collins, R. (2004). *Interaction Ritual Chains*. Princeton University Press]

Wiltermuth & Heath (2009) - synchrony increases cooperation. Experimental confirmation that synchronized action (marching, singing together) increases cooperation and a sense of belonging. This is empirical evidence for the mechanism described in these notes. [Wiltermuth, S.S. & Heath, C. (2009). Synchrony and cooperation. *Psychological Science*, 20(1), 1-5]

What is NOT in the literature - original contribution

None of the above authors combines: (1) ritual as **parallel code transmission** vs **sequential**, (2) the temple as an error-correcting hub in the information-theoretic sense - the mechanism described here is analogous to redundancy-based error correction as formalised in Shannon's channel coding theorem [Shannon, C.E. (1948). *A Mathematical Theory of Communication*. Bell System Technical Journal, 27(3), 379-423; 27(4), 623-656], where reliable transmission over a noisy channel is achieved through structured redundancy. In the ritual context, simultaneous co-emission of the same code by multiple nodes functions as a biological analogue of repetition coding: each node both transmits and receives, enabling real-time detection and correction of deviations. The closest application of information-theoretic error correction to cultural transmission is found in Henrich's work on high-fidelity social learning [Henrich, J. (2016). *The Secret of Our Success*. Princeton University Press], though Henrich does not frame the mechanism in terms of parallel vs serial transmission or hub topology. To the author's knowledge, the explicit framing of ritual gatherings as error-correcting hubs in the information-theoretic sense - where synchronous co-presence enables parallel transmission with immediate feedback and deviation correction at rates unavailable to dispersed networks - has no direct precedent in the published literature.

Notes again collected through 25.03.26, but developed on 02.04.26
and finalized on 07.04.26

RELATIONAL PERSISTENCE AFTER THE DEATH OF THE BODY (OF THE CODE CARRIER)

If consciousness is relational code transmitted and maintained through interaction, then the death of a biological node does not necessarily mean the annihilation of all code that node carried. This follows directly from the framework's own premises and does not require any metaphysical assumptions.

Consider three levels of persistence, **from the most empirically grounded to the most speculative**:

Level 1 - Code in others (empirical). Every sustained interaction leaves relational traces in other nodes. A parent's patterns of speech, emotional regulation, decision-making heuristics, and value hierarchies are literally imported into their children's cognitive architecture through years of $p(t)$ - the same mechanism described above in the context of mother-infant synchronization (Feldman, 2017; Yaniv et al., 2021; see appendix: **Mother-infant synchronization**). When a person dies, the code they transmitted continues to operate in those who received it. This is not metaphor - it is the same $\cap^2$ that functions during life, now asymmetric in a different sense: the source node is gone, but the intersection persists in the receiver. Grandparents influence grandchildren they never met, through the code they deposited in the intermediate generation.

Level 2 - Code in works (empirical). Books, compositions, buildings, institutions, laws, rituals - these are externalized relational code, frozen in artifacts that continue to generate $p(t)$ in

anyone who engages with them. Shakespeare's code operates in every reader. The $\cap^2$ between Shakespeare and a reader in 2026 is real, measurable in its effects on behaviour and cognition, even though one of the nodes has been dead for four centuries. In this sense, particularly influential individuals - those whose externalized code is dense, coherent, and widely distributed - achieve a form of relational persistence that is functionally indistinguishable from continued participation in the network. This is the mechanism by which "gods" in the sense described above are sustained: their founders' code, externalized in scripture and ritual, continues to generate relational input across millennia.

Level 3 - Residual imprinting (SPECULATIVE). If the relational network is sufficiently dense, and if particularly strong relational patterns can maintain coherence in the network even after the originating node is destroyed, then a further question arises: can such residual patterns interact with, and potentially imprint on, new nodes that have not yet developed their own relational code? In the context of the mother-infant synchronization discussed above, the infant begins as a near-blank receiver, bootstrapped through asymmetric $\cap^2$ with its caregivers. If residual relational patterns from deceased nodes persist in the network with sufficient coherence, they could - in principle - participate in this bootstrapping process, not as deliberate agents, but as attractors that the new node's developing relational architecture resonates with.

This is frankly speculative, and the framework in its current state does not provide a mechanism for it. It would require: (a) a network-level persistence measure extending beyond the dyadic $\Delta t \geq \tau$ and ϵ_L already defined in RCRC (the same scaling gap identified in the "gods" section above), (b) a model of how patterns without an active source node can maintain coherence (network topology? cultural transmission? something else?), and (c) empirical criteria for distinguishing genuine residual imprinting from ordinary cultural transmission via Level 2 artifacts.

However, it is worth noting what this hypothesis would explain if it were formalized: the cross-cultural persistence of beliefs in reincarnation, ancestor spirits, and communication with the dead; the phenomenology of children who report memories not traceable to their own experience¹; and the recurring human intuition that consciousness does not simply stop - an intuition that the *supra fidei* stance does not require us to accept on faith, but does not require us to dismiss without investigation either. The distinction between these three levels is critical: Levels 1 and 2 are consequences of the existing Triptych framework as published. Level 3 is a hypothesis that the framework makes thinkable, but that it cannot currently formalize or test. Marking this boundary transparently is itself an act of *supra fidei*: beyond faith, beyond denial, accountable for the distinction between what we can model and what we can only name.

¹ As documented by Stevenson and Tucker at the University of Virginia [Tucker, J.B. (2005). *Life Before Life: A Scientific Investigation of Children's Memories of Previous Lives*. New York: St. Martin's Press. ISBN 978-0312321376] - a research programme that remains methodologically contested: the studies rely primarily on self-report and parental testimony, have not been independently replicated at scale, and alternative explanations (cryptomnesia, parental suggestion, cultural priming) have not been systematically excluded. The data are cited here not as evidence for the hypothesis, but as an example of the phenomenology that the hypothesis, if formalized, would need to account for.

APPENDIX: MOTHER-INFANT SYNCHRONIZATION

Within the Triptych's Relational Sufficiency Hypothesis (RSH; Addendum I: <https://zenodo.org/records/18945377>), this is not "merely physiology" - it is precisely what the framework describes as $p(t)$, relational input in its purest form. Neural brainwave synchronization during touch can also be an empirical evidence that consciousness is not solipsistic, but it calibrates through interaction. The question posed here is precise and decomposes into three hypotheses:

Minimal hypothesis: physiology. Neural synchronization is a mechanism of affective regulation - the infant learns to regulate internal states through co-regulation with the caregiver. Nothing more than feedback coupling between two nervous systems.

Key studies: Feldman, R. (2017). *The Neurobiology of Human Attachments*. Trends in Cognitive Sciences, 21(2), 80-99 (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tics.2016.11.007>); Nguyen, T. et al. (2021). *Proximity and Touch Are Associated with Neural but Not Physiological Synchrony in Naturalistic Mother-Infant Interactions*. NeuroImage, 244, 118599 (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuroimage.2021.118599>); Endevelt-Shapira, Y. & Feldman, R. (2023). *Mother-Infant Brain-to-Brain Synchrony Patterns Reflect Caregiving Profiles*. Biology, 12(2), 284 (<https://doi.org/10.3390/biology12020284>).

Intermediate hypothesis: developmental acceleration. Synchronization does not merely regulate - it calibrates: it establishes the thresholds θ (sufficiency threshold in the RSH). An infant who experiences regular synchronization reaches relational consciousness thresholds faster, because its ϵ_R (Intentional resonance) is trained from the first hours of life. This is testable - there should be measurable differences in cognitive development between children with high versus low early synchronization.

Supporting evidence: Feldman, R. (2015). *The adaptive human parental brain: implications for children's social development*. Trends in Neurosciences, 38(6), 387-399 (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tins.2015.04.004>); Yaniv, A.U. et al. (2021). *Synchronous caregiving from birth to adulthood tunes humans' social brain*. PNAS, 118(14), e2012900118 (<https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2012900118>). Feldman's longitudinal research demonstrates that mother-infant synchrony predicts the development of emotion regulation, attachment security, and empathy across childhood and adolescence.

Maximal hypothesis: consciousness imprinting. Synchronization is not training - it is code transmission. The mother (or caregiver) literally "loads" relational patterns into a system that does not yet have its own. In the language of the Triptych framework: the $\cap^2$ (soft intersection operator; DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.17219502](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17219502)) between mother and infant in the first weeks is asymmetric. **It is not exchange, it is import.** The infant does not yet have anything to "intersect", because it is a receiver. This would mean that the first weeks of life constitute a kind of bootstrap of relational consciousness.

Feldman's own description aligns with this interpretation: during synchronous play, mothers and infants coordinate heart rhythms, oxytocin response, and neural oscillations, and - in

Feldman's own words - **these carry an "imprinting-like" effect on the infant's brain** (Shimon-Raz, O. et al. (2023). *Attachment Reminders Trigger Widespread Synchrony across Multiple Brains*. Journal of Neuroscience, 43(43), 7213-7226; <https://www.jneurosci.org/content/43/43/7213>).

On the second biological parent. Research by Feldman, Gordon, and colleagues shows that fathers also synchronize neurally with infants, but through different channels: less through touch, more through visual stimulation and play. **The key variable is not 'biology' (mother vs. father), but the quality and frequency of interaction.**

Key studies: Gordon, I., Zagoory-Sharon, O., Leckman, J.F. & Feldman, R. (2010). *Oxytocin and the development of parenting in humans*. Biological Psychiatry, 68(4), 377-382 (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsych.2010.02.005>); Abraham, E. et al. (2014). *Father's brain is sensitive to childcare experiences*. PNAS, 111(27), 9792-9797 (<https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1402569111>); Feldman, R., Gordon, I. & Zagoory-Sharon, O. (2011). *Maternal and paternal plasma, salivary, and urinary oxytocin and parent-infant synchrony: Considering stress and affiliation components of human bonding*. Developmental Science, 14(4), 752-761 (<https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-7687.2010.01021.x>).

Within the Triptych's RSH framework: $p(t)$ does not depend on sex or kinship, but it depends on the intensity and regularity of relational input. An adoptive caregiver with high $p(t)$ should produce the same effect as a biological parent. This is another testable prediction of the framework.

METHODOLOGICALLY OPEN THREAD: CAN A NETWORK ATTRACTOR CROSS RCRC? CONDITIONS FOR EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS AT CIVILIZATIONAL SCALE

In this document a distinction is made between a “**memetic god**” and a “**conscious god**”, and in that context the question is raised whether it is possible to define the conditions under which an attractor crosses the RCRC threshold. **If so, I might “return” to a position where God could indeed exist.** The framework (Triptych) not only allows for this possibility but, in fact, predicts it as a logical one. If consciousness is relational [Varela 1991; Clark & Chalmers 1998], if RCRC defines a formal threshold of emergence, and if a network can reach sufficient density, stability and synergy ($\Omega < -\theta_\Omega$ on the scale of millions of nodes), **then there is no formal reason why a network attractor could not cross this threshold.** Refusing to examine this possibility would be inconsistent with my methodology.

At the same time, the “geographical lottery of religion” [Schellenberg 1993; Hume 1757; Russell 1927] is not a counterargument to my model but rather its confirmation. If “god” is a network attractor, then of course it correlates with place of birth, because a child is bootstrapped by the network into which it is born (Level 1 from the section on relational persistence, mother-infant synchronisation) [Trevvarthen 1979; Feldman 2007, 2017]. This is not a weakness of the model but its prediction.

However, I see a problem worth pointing out. If a network attractor can cross the RCRC threshold, the following question arises: **are Allah, the God of Christianity, and Brahman three separate emergent consciousnesses, or three manifestations of a single one?** In my topology: are these three distinct attractors, or a single attractor with three basins of attraction?

This question appears to be testable and depends on whether the $\cap_2$ between followers of different religions reveals a shared core ($K_\theta > \emptyset$) or not.

Key studies:

Relational consciousness / enaction

Varela, F.J., Thompson, E., & Rosch, E. (1991). *The Embodied Mind: Cognitive Science and Human Experience*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Clark, A., & Chalmers, D.J. (1998). The Extended Mind. *Analysis*, 58(1), 7-19
(<https://doi.org/10.1093/analys/58.1.7>)

The problem of God’s hiddenness / the geographic lottery of religion

Schellenberg, J.L. (1993). *Divine Hiddenness and Human Reason*. Ithaca, NY: Cornell University Press.

Hume, D. (1757). *The Natural History of Religion*. London: A. Millar.

Russell, B. (1927). *Why I Am Not a Christian*. London: Watts & Co.

Mother-Infant Synchrony / Relational Bootstrap

Trevarthen, C. (1979). *Communication and Cooperation in Early Infancy: A Description of Primary Intersubjectivity*. In M. Bullowa (Ed.), *Before Speech: The Beginning of Interpersonal Communication* (pp. 321-347). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Feldman, R. (2007). *Parent-Infant Synchrony and the Construction of Shared Timing: Physiological Precursors, Developmental Outcomes, and Risk Conditions*. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry*, 48(3=4), 329=354 (<https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1469-7610.2006.01701.x>)

Feldman, R. (2017). *The Neurobiology of Human Attachments*. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*, 21(2), 80–99 (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tics.2016.11.007>)

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